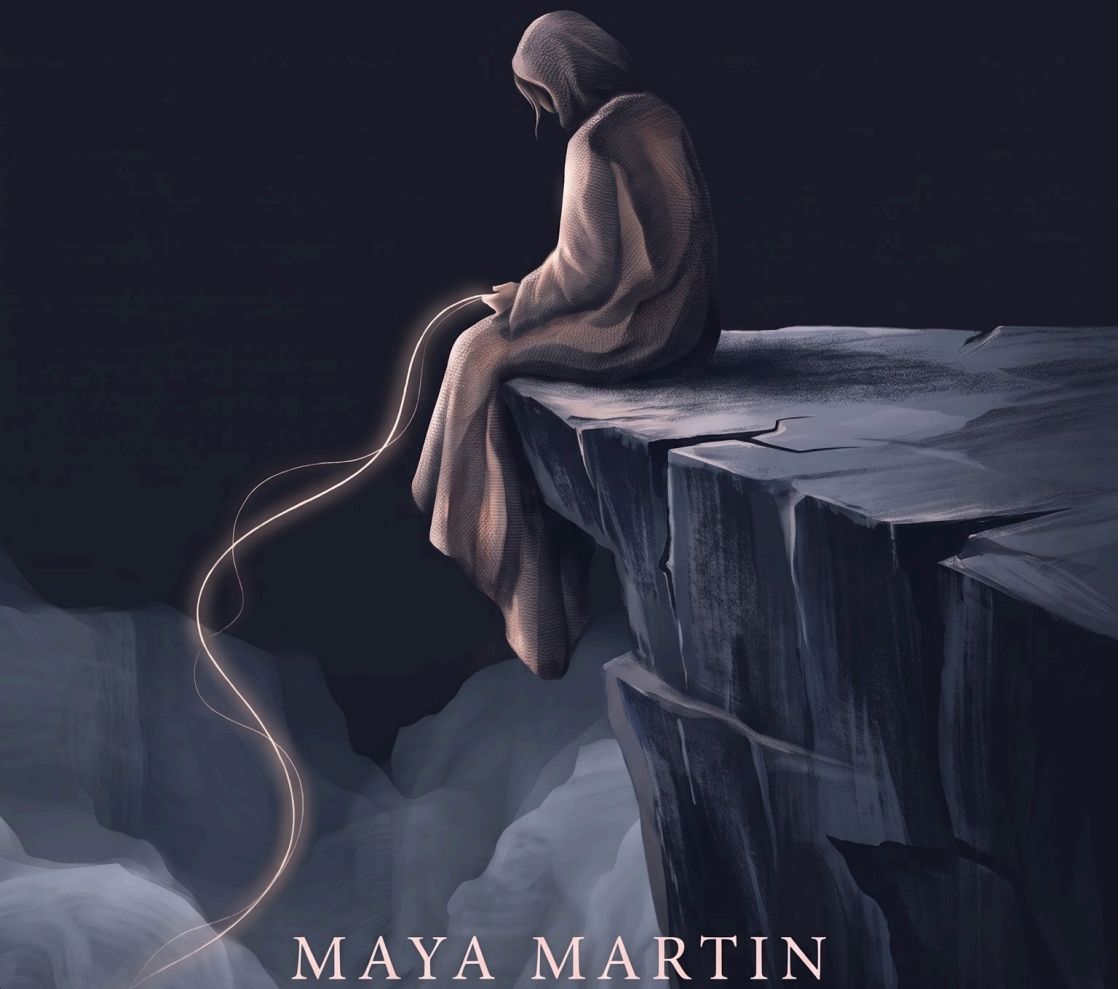
HOW DO I LET GO?

A Practical Guide to Moving On When You Still Love Your Ex



MAYA MARTIN



A GENTLE GUIDE TO HEALING

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CHAPTER 01

I Know You're Hurting

Hey, friend.

First, take a deep breath.

I don't know exactly what happened between you and the person you once loved, but I want you to know something: I understand that letting go is not always easy.

Maybe you still wake up thinking about them. Maybe something funny happens during your day, and your first thought is to tell them about it. Then you remember that things are no longer the same.

> *"How can someone who once meant everything to me become someone I can no longer talk to?"*

I know those feelings can be painful.

The hardest part of a breakup is not always losing the person. Sometimes, it's losing the little things you became used to.

The morning messages. The random phone calls. The silly jokes. The feeling of having someone to talk to after a long day.

You miss the relationship, the friendship and even the future you imagined together.

> *"You can miss someone and still accept that they are no longer meant to be part of your life."*

Those two things can exist together. This book is not here to tell you to stop feeling. You are human, and your feelings matter.

Instead, I want us to work through this together. We will talk about why letting go feels difficult, how to stop holding on to painful memories, how to handle the urge to contact your ex and how to slowly find yourself again.

There is no competition here. You don't have to heal faster than anyone else. Just take it one day at a time.

> **You are still here. Your story is still going. And there are beautiful days ahead of you.**

Let's begin.

CHAPTER 02

Why Is Letting Go So Difficult?

Have you ever wondered why it's so difficult to forget someone, even when you know the relationship is over?

You tell yourself that you are moving on. You promise yourself that you won't think about them again.

But a song plays, a familiar place reminds you of them, or you see something they would have loved. Suddenly, all those feelings come rushing back.

1 You became used to having them around

When someone becomes part of your daily routine, their absence can feel strange. You might be used to sending them messages every morning or calling them before bed.

2 You remember the good times

Sometimes, your mind plays back the beautiful moments. You remember the laughter, the gifts, the dates and the promises.

3 You are attached to the future you imagined

Perhaps you imagined getting married, travelling together, or growing old beside that person. Now that future feels impossible. You are allowed to grieve it.

4 You are waiting for an explanation

Maybe things ended suddenly or you never received the apology you wanted. A lack of explanation does not mean you must remain stuck forever.

A Little Exercise

Take a notebook and answer these three questions honestly:

1. What do I miss most about this person?
2. What made the relationship difficult or painful?
3. What do I need to accept so I can begin moving forward?

CHAPTER 03

Accepting That It's Over

Friend, this may be one of the hardest parts. Acceptance.

You might still love them. You might still wish things had worked out. You might even believe that the two of you could find your way back to each other.

But healing begins when you stop fighting the reality of what has happened.

> *"How much of my life am I putting on hold because I am waiting for someone?"*

Acceptance does not mean you are happy about the breakup. It simply means you are choosing to stop allowing the past to control your present.

You deserve to live your life now. If someone has clearly ended the relationship, respect that decision, even when it hurts. Don't force conversations or chase explanations.

Understand this important truth

You cannot control how someone feels about you. You cannot force someone to love you. But you can control how you respond. You can choose to respect yourself and protect your peace.

Try This Today

"I may not like how things ended, but I accept that they have ended. I am allowed to move forward."

Read it whenever you find yourself hoping that things will return to the way they were. Keep reminding yourself that acceptance is a choice you can practise.

CHAPTER 04

Stop Living in the Memories

Let's be honest. Old pictures can be dangerous when you are trying to move on.

You open your gallery, and suddenly you are looking through hundreds of old memories. You see their smile. You remember what they said. And before you know it, you are crying or wishing you could return.

> *"Memories are allowed to exist without becoming the place where you live."*

You don't have to hate your ex to move forward. You simply need to stop using the past as a reason to avoid your present.

What to do with old pictures and messages:

- Move old pictures into a separate folder so they are not constantly appearing.
- Archive conversations that you keep reopening.
- Put gifts somewhere out of sight if they make healing harder.
- Stop rereading old messages whenever you feel lonely.

CHAPTER 05

Stop Checking Their Social Media

You say you are moving on, but somehow you still know when your ex is online. You check their stories and new pictures. When you see something you don't like, your mood changes immediately.

"After checking their profile, do I usually feel better or worse?"

CHAPTER 06

What to Do When You Miss Them

Missing someone can happen at the most unexpected times. You might be having a wonderful day, and suddenly something reminds you of them.

> *"Missing someone is a feeling, not an instruction."*

Just because you miss them doesn't mean you should call them. Just because you feel lonely doesn't mean you should return to a relationship that was not right for you.

5 Things to Do When You Miss Your Ex:

1. Talk to someone you trust.
2. Get out of your room and change your environment.
3. Write what you wish you could tell them (do not send it).
4. Do something you enjoy.
5. Remind yourself why you are choosing to move forward.

CHAPTER 07

Resist the Urge to Contact Them

Before sending an emotional message, give yourself 24 hours. Write it in your notes first. Ask yourself whether sending it is truly necessary or whether you were simply trying to escape a painful feeling.

> *"I will not use temporary loneliness as a reason to return to something I am trying to heal from."*

CHAPTER 08

Forgive Yourself

There is a difference between taking responsibility and blaming yourself for everything. A relationship involves two people. You can acknowledge your mistakes without carrying responsibility for every decision the other person made.

CHAPTER 09

Rediscover Who You Are

Reconnect with yourself. Return to your interests, reconnect with family and friends, and set new goals for your own personal growth.

> *"You were a whole person before you met your ex. You are still a whole person now."*

CHAPTER 10

Healthy Emotional Boundaries

A boundary is simply a decision about what you will and will not allow in your life. Limit unnecessary communication and protect your peace without anger.

CHAPTER 11

Your 7-Day Letting-Go Challenge

DAY 1: Be Honest With Yourself

Write one page about your feelings without judging yourself.

DAY 2: Accept What Happened

Write: "I cannot change what happened, but I can choose what I do next."

DAY 3: Create Social Media Distance

Spend the day without visiting their profile or checking updates.

DAY 4: Make Space for Yourself

Spend 30 minutes doing something that makes you feel good.

DAY 5: Stop Blaming Yourself

Write down three things you have learned about love and relationships.

DAY 6: Build a New Routine

Create a simple daily routine that gives you something positive to focus on.

DAY 7: Choose Your Future

Write a letter to your future self describing the life you want to build.

Progress is not always about feeling happy every day. Sometimes, progress is simply choosing not to do something that hurts you.

CHAPTER 12

Daily Affirmations

- *1. I am worthy of love, care and respect.*
- *2. My relationship ending does not make me a failure.*
- *3. I can miss someone without going back to them.*
- *4. I deserve a relationship where I feel valued.*
- *5. I am allowed to take my time healing.*
- *6. I will not beg someone to see my worth.*
- *7. I am learning to choose myself.*

CHAPTER 13

A Letter to the Heart Still Holding On

Dear Friend,

I wish I could sit beside you for a moment and remind you that everything will not feel this heavy forever.

Look at how much you have been carrying. You have spent so much time thinking about someone else that you may have forgotten to ask yourself how you are doing.

Are you eating well? Are you sleeping? Are you giving yourself the same care you once gave them?

Please don't allow one painful chapter to convince you that the whole story will be sad. You deserve to feel loved, safe and happy.

With love,
Maya Martin

CHAPTER 14

You Deserve to Be Happy Again

Letting go is not about pretending you never loved someone. It is about accepting that something has ended and deciding that your future still matters.

> *"Don't spend the rest of your life waiting for someone to come back and make you happy. Start building a life that makes you happy, whether they return or not."*

So, dear friend, take a deep breath. Let yesterday be yesterday. Give yourself permission to begin again. There is still a beautiful life waiting for you.

A FINAL NOTE TO THE READER

Thank you for allowing me to be part of your healing journey. Keep practising the little things that bring you peace. Your next chapter can still be beautiful.